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BoardMeets

Comprehensive User Guide

Board Management & Governance Platform

Version 2.0 · April 2026

This document provides complete guidance on using the BoardMeets platform,
covering all features from meeting management to voting, documents, and administration.

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1. Introduction & Getting Started

1.1 What is BoardMeets?

BoardMeets is a comprehensive board management and governance platform designed for organizations that need to manage boards, committees, meetings, documents, voting, and action items in a secure, multi-tenant environment. It streamlines the entire board meeting lifecycle — from scheduling and agenda preparation through to minutes, resolutions, and follow-up actions.

Key Capabilities

- **Board Management** — Create and manage multiple boards with governance rules, member roles, and settings
- **Meeting Lifecycle** — Full meeting workflow from creation through minutes approval
- **Board Pack / Document Viewer** — Unified document viewer with PDF rendering for meeting materials
- **Electronic Voting** — Formal voting with multiple vote types and quorum tracking
- **Action Item Tracking** — Assign, track, and follow up on tasks with progress monitoring
- **Real-time Messaging** — Instant messaging with direct, group, and context-specific chat rooms
- **Document Management** — Upload, organize, permission, and version-control documents
- **Committee Management** — Create and manage standing, ad-hoc, and special committees
- **Analytics & Audit Trails** — Governance health metrics, activity charts, and full audit logging
- **Multi-tenant & Subsidiary Support** — Parent/subsidiary tenant hierarchy with tenant isolation

1.2 System Requirements

REQUIREMENT	DETAILS
Browser	Google Chrome (latest), Mozilla Firefox (latest), Safari 16+, Microsoft Edge (latest)
Internet	Stable broadband connection required for real-time features
Screen	Minimum 1024×768; optimized for 1280×800 and above. Responsive on tablets and mobile
JavaScript	Must be enabled in browser settings

1.3 Logging In

1. Navigate to your organization's BoardMeets URL (e.g., `boardmeets.coseke.cloud`).
2. Enter your **email address** and **password**.
3. Optionally check **"Remember me"** to stay logged in across sessions.
4. If your organization has enabled **two-factor authentication (2FA)**, enter the verification code from your authenticator app.
5. Click **Sign In**. You will be directed to your dashboard.

> ℹ️ **Forgot Your Password?**
>
> Click **"Forgot Password"** on the login page. Enter your email address to receive a password reset link. The link expires after a set period determined by your organization's security policy.

> ⚠️ **Account Lockout**
>
> After multiple failed login attempts (configured by your administrator), your account will be temporarily locked. Contact your organization's administrator if you are locked out.

1.4 Navigating the Interface

The BoardMeets interface consists of three main areas:

Sidebar Navigation (Left)

The collapsible sidebar provides access to all major sections of the application:

GROUP	ITEMS
Main	Home (Dashboard), Search, Meetings, Notifications, Boards, Directory
Secondary	Action Items, Messenger, Votes, Resources
Settings (varies by role)	General, Profile, Preferences, Users, Departments, Roles, Organization, License, Audit Logs

Header Bar (Top)

Contains the page title, breadcrumb navigation, theme toggle (light/dark mode), notification bell, and user profile menu.

Main Content Area

Displays the active page content. Most pages support grid, list, or calendar views where applicable.

> 💡 **Quick Search**
> Press `⌘` + `K` (Mac) or `Ctrl` + `K` (Windows) to open global search from anywhere in the application. Search across meetings, boards, documents, votes, and action items.

1.5 User Roles Overview

BoardMeets uses a layered role system. Your capabilities depend on both your **system role** and your **board-level role(s)**.

System Roles

ROLE	DESCRIPTION
Super Admin	System-wide administrator with access across all tenants. Uses a separate login page. Manages tenants, system configuration, and global audit logs.
Tenant Admin	Organization administrator with full control within their tenant. Manages users, roles, departments, settings, branding, subsidiaries, and has access to all boards and meetings.
User	Standard user. Access is determined by board membership and assigned permissions/roles.

Board-Level Roles

ROLE	LEVEL	CAPABILITIES
Board Chair	100	Full board management — create/edit/approve meetings, manage members, governance settings, approve minutes
Vice Chair	90	Board management — similar to Chair, acts in Chair's absence
Treasurer	85	Financial oversight — board management with emphasis on financial reporting
Secretary	80	Meeting & document focus — manages minutes, documents, agendas, attendance records
Member	50	Standard participation — attend meetings, vote, view documents, complete action items
Observer	10	Read-only access — view meetings, documents, and board information. Cannot vote or edit.

Committee Roles

ROLE	LEVEL	CAPABILITIES
Committee Chair	70	Full committee management — schedule committee meetings, manage members
Committee Member	40	Standard committee participation — attend, contribute, view materials

2. Dashboard

The Dashboard is your home page and provides an at-a-glance overview of everything that needs your attention.

2.1 User Dashboard

The standard user dashboard includes the following widgets and sections:

Next Meeting Hero

A prominent card showing your soonest upcoming meeting with a countdown timer and a **Join** button (for virtual meetings). Click to navigate to the meeting detail page.

Statistics Grid

Overview cards displaying key metrics at a glance:

- **Active Boards** — Number of boards you belong to
- **Upcoming Meetings** — Meetings scheduled in the future
- **Pending Documents** — Documents requiring your review
- **Active Votes** — Open votes awaiting your participation
- **Open Action Items** — Action items assigned to you
- **Unread Messages** — Messages you haven't seen yet

Priority Action Queue

Shows your most urgent action items (up to 6) sorted by due date. Items nearing or past their deadline are highlighted.

Pending Approvals

Meetings awaiting your approval decision (up to 5). Click to review and approve or reject.

Active Votes

Votes currently open that require your participation. Shows vote title, closing time, and a button to cast your vote.

Pending Signatures

Action items that require your signature. Shows the document/item awaiting signature with a direct link.

Recent Activity Feed

A chronological list of recent activities across your boards, including meetings completed, documents uploaded, votes created, and action items assigned.

Quick Actions

Shortcut buttons for common tasks: Schedule Meeting, Upload Document, Create Vote, and more.

Governance Scorecard

Health metrics for your organization's governance including attendance rates, meeting frequency compliance, and voting participation.

2.2 Tenant Admin Dashboard

Tenant Administrators see all standard dashboard widgets plus organization-wide management views, providing visibility across all boards, all users, and tenant-level statistics. Admin dashboards can see activity across all boards in the tenant, even without being a member of each board.

3. Boards

Boards are the foundational organizational unit in BoardMeets. Each board represents a governing body (e.g., a corporate board of directors, advisory committee, or non-profit board).

3.1 Viewing Boards

Navigate to **Boards** in the sidebar. You will see all boards you have access to displayed as cards or in a list. Each card shows:

- Board name and type badge (Corporate , Non-Profit , Advisory)
- Number of members
- Your role on the board
- Board status (Active , Inactive , Draft , Archived)
- Quick stats: upcoming meetings, pending items

Click any board to view its detail page, which contains sub-pages for Overview, Members, Meetings, Committees, Settings, and Analytics.

3.2 Creating a Board

Required Permission: `board:create` or Tenant Admin

1. Click **"New Board"** on the Boards page or use the Board Wizard.
2. Enter the board details:
   - 3. **Name** — A clear, descriptive board name
   - 4. **Description** — Purpose and scope of the board
   - 5. **Board Type** — Corporate, Non-Profit, or Advisory
   - 6. **Meeting Frequency** — How often the board meets
7. Configure governance rules (optional):
   - 8. Term length and maximum consecutive terms
   - 9. Meeting notice period (days)
   - 10. Quorum percentage requirement

    - 11 Voting threshold (majority required to pass)
    - 12 Whether proxy voting, virtual meetings, or meeting recording is allowed
    - 13 Conflict of interest policy
    - 14 Code of conduct
15. Add initial board members and assign their roles.
16. Review and save. The board status will be set based on your selection (Active or Draft).

3.3 Board Members & Roles

Each board member is assigned a role that determines their permissions within that board.

Adding Members

1. Navigate to the board's **Members** tab.
2. Click **"Add Member"**.
3. Search for users by name or email.
4. Select the member's role (Chair, Vice Chair, Secretary, Treasurer, Member, or Observer).
5. Click **Add** to confirm.

Managing Members

- Change a member's role using the role selector dropdown
- Set member status: Active, Inactive, or Resigned
- Use bulk operations for managing multiple members at once

3.4 Board Settings & Governance

Board Chairs and administrators can configure board-level settings:

Meeting Defaults

- Default meeting duration
- Auto-generate agenda and minutes
- Enable electronic voting

- Require attendance confirmation
- Allow guest attendees

Privacy Settings

- Meeting privacy: Public, Private, or Members Only
- Document privacy: Public, Private, or Members Only

Integration Settings

- **Calendar Integration** — Google Calendar, Microsoft Outlook, Apple Calendar
- **Video Conferencing** — Zoom, Microsoft Teams, Google Meet, WebEx
- **Document Storage** — Google Drive, SharePoint, Dropbox

Virtual Meetings

Enable or disable virtual meetings at the board level using the **Allow Virtual Meetings** toggle. When disabled, meetings for this board cannot be set as virtual.

3.5 Board Analytics

Navigate to the board's **Analytics** tab to view performance metrics including meeting attendance rates, voting participation, action item completion rates, and document activity.

4. Meetings

Meetings are the core workflow in BoardMeets. The platform supports the complete meeting lifecycle from scheduling through follow-up.

4.1 Meeting List & Tabs

Navigate to **Meetings** in the sidebar. The meeting list is organized into tabs, each showing meetings filtered by status:

TAB	STATUS FILTER	DESCRIPTION
Upcoming	Scheduled	Meetings that have been approved and are scheduled for the future. Sorted soonest first.
Pending Approval	Pending Approval	Meetings submitted for approval but not yet approved or rejected.
In Progress	In Progress	Meetings that are currently live/active.
Completed	Completed	Meetings that have ended. Sorted most recent first.
Drafts	Draft	Meetings created but not yet published or submitted for approval.
Cancelled	Cancelled	Meetings that were cancelled. Sorted most recent first.
All	—	All meetings regardless of status.

Each tab shows a badge with the **total count** of meetings in that category. Use the search bar to filter meetings by title or description. Toggle between **Grid**, **List**, and **Calendar** views using the view mode buttons.

> ℹ️ **Pagination**
>
> Each tab loads 20 meetings at a time. Click **"Load More"** at the bottom to fetch additional meetings.

4.2 Creating a Meeting

Required Permission: `meeting:create` or Board Chair/Secretary/Tenant Admin

Click **"New Meeting"** to launch the 7-step Meeting Creation Wizard:

Step 1: Details

- **Title** — Name of the meeting
- **Description** — Purpose and context
- **Meeting Type**:
  - Regular — Standard board meeting
  - Special — Special purpose meeting
  - Emergency — Urgent meeting requiring immediate attention
  - Annual — Annual general meeting
- **Board** — Select the board this meeting belongs to
- **Committee** (optional) — Associate with a specific committee

Step 2: Schedule

- **Date & Time** — When the meeting will take place
- **Duration** — Expected length in minutes
- **Location** — Physical venue address
- **Virtual Meeting** — Toggle to enable virtual meeting, then provide:
  - Meeting URL
  - Meeting ID (optional)
  - Meeting Password (optional)
- **Allow Public Access** — Whether non-members can view the meeting

Step 3: Attendees

- Select attendees from the board's member list
- Assign attendee roles:

  - **Chair** — Meeting chairperson
  - **Presenter** — Presenter for specific agenda items
  - **Attendee** — Regular participant
  - **Observer** — View-only access

Step 4: Agenda

Build the meeting agenda by adding items:

- **Title** & **Description**
- **Presenter** — Who will present this item
- **Duration** — Time allocated (minutes)
- **Item Type**:
  - Discussion — Open discussion topic
  - Decision — Requires a decision
  - Information — Informational / FYI
  - Action — Action-required item
- **Voting Required** — Flag to indicate a vote is needed
- **Confidential** — Mark as confidential
- **Background Info & Expected Outcome**
- **Sub-items** — Nest child agenda items under a parent (e.g., 4.1, 4.1.1)
- **Document Attachments** — Attach supporting documents to specific agenda items

Step 5: Documents

- Upload documents to include in the meeting's board pack
- Set category, description, and confidentiality for each document
- Link documents to specific agenda items

Step 6: Approval

- Select an approver who must approve the meeting before it becomes scheduled
- If no approval is required, the meeting can be published directly as "Scheduled"

Step 7: Review

- Review all entered information across all steps
- Submit as Draft (save for later) or Scheduled / Pending Approval

Draft → Pending Approval → Scheduled → In Progress → Completed

4.3 Agenda Management

The Agenda tab on the meeting detail page displays all agenda items in order. Features include:

- Drag-and-drop reordering of items
- Visual indicators for item type, duration, and presenter
- Nested sub-items displayed hierarchically (e.g., item 4 → 4.1 → 4.1.1)
- Attached documents shown inline with each item
- Total meeting duration calculated from all items

4.4 Meeting Attendees & RSVP

The Attendees tab shows all invited members and their RSVP status:

RSVP STATUS	MEANING
Pending	No response yet
Accepted	Will attend
Declined	Cannot attend
Tentative	May attend

To RSVP:

1. Open the meeting detail page.
2. Click the RSVP button on the meeting card or in the Attendees tab.
3. Select your response: Accept, Decline, or Tentative.

Additional attendee information captured includes dietary requirements and accessibility needs.

4.5 Meeting Approval Workflow

When a meeting is submitted with an approver, it enters the `Pending Approval` status.

Approving/Rejecting a Meeting:

1. The approver receives a notification and sees the meeting in their **Pending Approvals** dashboard widget.
2. Click to review the meeting details, agenda, and documents.
3. Click **Approve** to move the meeting to `Scheduled` status, or **Reject** with a reason.

> ℹ️ **Approval History**
> The Approval tab on the meeting detail page shows the full approval history, including who approved/rejected and when, along with any comments.

4.6 Conducting a Meeting

Starting a Meeting

Required Permission: `meeting:edit` or Board Chair/Tenant Admin

1. Navigate to the meeting detail page.
2. Click **"Start Meeting"**. The status changes to `In Progress` .
3. All attendees receive a real-time alert notification.

During the Meeting

- View the agenda and supporting documents
- Conduct votes on agenda items flagged for voting
- Take notes/minutes using the Minutes editor
- Create action items in real-time
- Use the meeting chat for side discussions

Ending a Meeting

1. Click **"End Meeting"**. The status changes to `Completed` .
2. An audit log entry is recorded.

Restarting a Meeting

If a meeting was ended prematurely, users with edit permission can click **"Restart Meeting"** to change the status back to `Scheduled` .

Cancelling a Meeting

Users with delete permission can cancel a meeting, which changes its status to `Cancelled` . All attendees are notified.

4.7 Meeting Minutes

Meeting minutes are accessed from the **Minutes** tab on the meeting detail page.

Minutes Workflow

Draft → Review → Approved → Published

Creating & Editing Minutes

1. Navigate to the meeting's **Minutes** tab.
2. Use the **rich text editor** to compose or edit minutes. The editor supports headings, bold, italic, lists, tables, and more.
3. Minutes can be generated manually or with AI assistance.
4. Save as Draft to continue editing later.
5. When ready, submit for Review. The board chair or designated reviewer can then Approve or request changes.
6. Once approved, Publish the minutes to make them available to all attendees.

Minutes track: who recorded them, who reviewed them, who approved them, version history, and generation method.

4.8 Board Pack / Document Viewer

The **Documents** tab on the meeting detail page opens the Board Pack — a unified document viewer for all meeting materials.

Board Pack Features

- **Agenda Sidebar** — Left panel shows all agenda items. Click any item to jump to its associated documents.
- **Document Navigation** — Header shows "Document X of Y" to indicate your position within the pack.
- **PDF Viewer** — High-quality canvas-based PDF rendering with page-by-page scrolling.
- **Global Page Numbering** — A floating page indicator pill shows your current page across all documents (e.g., "Page 15 of 30").
- **Download** — Download individual documents.
- **Document Banners** — Dividers between documents clearly labelled "Document X of Y".
- **URL Persistence** — Refreshing the page preserves your current document position.

> 💡 **Tip**
>
> The board pack view includes the full application sidebar and header, so you can navigate to other sections without losing your place. Use the back button to return to the meeting detail page.

4.9 Meeting Calendar View

From the Meetings page, click the **Calendar** icon in the view toggle to switch to a calendar display. Meetings are shown as events on their scheduled dates. Click any event to navigate to the meeting detail page.

5. Documents

5.1 Document Library

Navigate to **Documents** in the sidebar to access the organization's document library. Documents can be associated with boards, meetings, committees, or managed independently.

5.2 Uploading Documents

Required Permission: `document:create`

1. Click **"Upload Document"** or navigate to Documents → New.
2. Select the file to upload. Supported formats include PDF, Word, Excel, PowerPoint, images, and more (configurable by your administrator).
3. Fill in document metadata:
    - 4. **Title** — Document name
    - 5. **Description** — Brief summary
    - 6. **Category** — Select from the available categories (see below)
    - 7. **Tags** — Searchable keywords
    - 8. **Confidential** — Mark as confidential to restrict visibility
    - 9. **Board/Meeting/Committee** — Associate with specific entities
10. Click **Upload**. Progress is shown during the upload.

5.3 Document Categories & Statuses

Categories

CATEGORY	TYPICAL USE
Agenda	Meeting agendas
Minutes	Approved meeting minutes
Report	Board reports, committee reports
Policy	Policy documents, bylaws
Legal	Legal documents, contracts
Financial	Financial statements, budgets
Presentation	Slides and presentations
General	General purpose documents

Document Statuses

STATUS	DESCRIPTION
Draft	Document is being prepared, not yet finalized
Review	Document is under review
Approved	Document has been approved and is final
Archived	Document is archived for historical reference

5.4 Document Viewer

Click any document to open the built-in document viewer and PDF renderer. Features include page navigation, zoom controls, and download. For documents within a meeting, the Board Pack viewer provides the enhanced experience described in Section 4.8.

Document Permissions

Document access can be controlled with granular permissions:

- **View** — Can see the document
- **Download** — Can download a copy
- **Edit** — Can modify document metadata

- **Delete** — Can remove the document
- **Share** — Can share with other users
- **Admin** — Full control over the document

5.5 Resources (File Manager)

The **Resources** section (accessible from the sidebar) provides a traditional file manager experience:

- **Folder Tree** — Create hierarchical folder structures to organize documents
- **Color-coded Folders** — Assign colors (amber, blue, green, red, purple, orange, pink, teal) for easy identification
- **Breadcrumb Navigation** — Navigate through folder paths
- **Upload to Folders** — Drag-and-drop or click to upload files into specific folders
- **Grid/List View** — Toggle between visual layouts
- **Search** — Search within the current folder or across all resources

6. Voting

BoardMeets provides a formal electronic voting system with multiple vote types, quorum tracking, and detailed result analytics.

6.1 Understanding Vote Types

VOTE TYPE	THRESHOLD	DESCRIPTION
Simple Majority	> 50% of votes cast	More than half of members who actually voted must vote in favor. Non-voters are excluded from the calculation.
Absolute Majority	> 50% of all eligible voters	More than half of all eligible voters must vote in favor, including those who did not vote.
Super Majority	≥ 66.67% of votes cast	Two-thirds of members who voted must vote in favor. Used for significant decisions like amendments.
Unanimous	100%	All voters must agree. A single dissenting vote causes the motion to fail.

6.2 Creating a Vote

Required Permission: `vote:create`

1. Navigate to **Votes → New Vote** or create one from within a meeting.
2. Fill in vote details:
    - 3. **Title** — Clear description of what is being voted on
    - 4. **Description** — Context and background
    - 5. **Resolution Text** — The formal resolution text
    - 6. **Vote Type** — Simple, Majority, Super Majority, or Unanimous
    - 7. **Required Threshold** — Auto-set based on vote type, or custom

- 8 **Options** — Default: "For", "Against", "Abstain" (customizable)
- 9 **Voting Opens At** — Start date/time
- 10 **Voting Closes At** — End date/time
- 11 **Anonymous Voting** — Toggle to hide individual vote choices
- 12 **Allow Delegate Voting** — Allow voting on behalf of another member
- 13 **Require Rationale** — Require voters to explain their choice

14. Associate the vote with a board and optionally a meeting or agenda item.
15. Save as Draft or Open immediately.

Vote Statuses

Draft → Open → Closed

Votes can also be Cancelled at any time before closing.

6.3 Casting Your Vote

Required Permission: `vote:participate`

1. Open votes appear on your Dashboard under **Active Votes** and in the Votes list.
2. Click the vote to view the resolution text and options.
3. Select your vote option (e.g., For, Against, Abstain).
4. If required, enter your rationale explaining your choice.
5. Optionally set a confidence level (1–5 stars).
6. Click **Submit Vote**. Your vote is recorded and cannot be changed.

> ⚠️ **Important**
>
> Once submitted, votes cannot be changed. Review your selection carefully before confirming. If a rationale is required, you must provide one before your vote can be submitted.

6.4 Vote Results & Statistics

After a vote closes, the results page displays:

- **Result**: Passed , Failed , Tied , or No Quorum
- **Option Breakdown** — Bar chart showing votes per option with percentages
- **Participation Rate** — Percentage of eligible voters who cast a vote
- **Quorum Status** — Whether quorum was met
- **Individual Responses** — Who voted and how (unless anonymous)
- **Average Response Time** — How quickly members voted
- **Responses by Time** — Chart showing when votes were cast

7. Action Items

Action Items track tasks, decisions, and follow-ups arising from meetings. BoardMeets provides a comprehensive system for creating, assigning, tracking, and completing action items.

7.1 Action Item List

Navigate to **Action Items** in the sidebar. The list can be filtered by:

- **Status** — Open, In Progress, Completed, Cancelled, Deferred
- **Priority** — Low, Medium, High, Urgent
- **Assignee** — Who is responsible
- **Board** — Which board the item relates to
- **Due Date** — Overdue, due this week, etc.
- **Type** — Filter by action item type

7.2 Creating Action Items

Required Permission: `action_item:create`

1. Click **"New Action Item"** from the Action Items page, or create one from within a meeting.
2. Fill in the details:
    - 3. **Title** — Clear, action-oriented description
    - 4. **Description** — Detailed information about the task
    - 5. **Type**:

TYPE	DESCRIPTION
Task	General task to be completed
Follow-up	Follow-up from a previous discussion
Decision	Decision that needs implementation
Research	Research or investigation needed
Approval	Requires formal approval
Document Signing	Requires document signature(s)

- 6 **Priority**: Low , Medium , High , Urgent
- 7 **Assigned To** — Select the responsible person
- 8 **Board** — Associated board
- 9 **Meeting** (optional) — Originating meeting
- 10 **Due Date** — Deadline for completion
- 11 **Estimated Hours** — Time estimate
- 12 **Dependencies** — Link to other action items that must be completed first

13 Save the action item.

7.3 Tracking & Progress

Status Workflow

Open → In Progress → Completed

Items can also be set to Deferred or Cancelled .

Progress Tracking

- **Progress Percentage** — Update from 0% to 100% using the progress bar
- **Completion Notes** — Add notes when marking as complete
- **Checklist** — Break the item into a sub-task checklist and check off items as completed

- **Overdue Alerts** — Items past their due date are highlighted and trigger notifications

7.4 Comments & Collaboration

Each action item has a comment thread where team members can:

- Post updates on progress
- Ask questions or provide clarification
- Share relevant links or information
- The assignee and creator receive notifications for new comments

7.5 Document Signing

Action items of type **Document Signing** include a specialized signing workflow:

- **PDF Field Placement** — Place signature fields on a PDF document indicating where signers must sign
- **Required Signers** — Designate which users must sign
- **Pending Signatures** — Appear on the signer's Dashboard under "Pending Signatures"
- **Signature Tracking** — View who has signed and who is still pending

8. Committees

Committees are sub-groups of a board, responsible for specific areas such as audit, finance, governance, or nominations.

8.1 Committee Types

TYPE	DESCRIPTION
Standing	Permanent committee that meets regularly (e.g., Audit Committee, Finance Committee)
Ad Hoc	Temporary committee formed for a specific purpose, dissolved once the task is complete
Special	Special-purpose committee with specific mandate (e.g., Investigation Committee)

8.2 Creating & Managing Committees

Required Permission: `committee:create`

1. Navigate to **Committees → New Committee**, or create from a board's Committees tab.
2. Fill in committee details:
   - 3 **Name** — Committee name
   - 4 **Description** — Purpose and mandate
   - 5 **Committee Type** — Standing, Ad Hoc, or Special
   - 6 **Board** — Parent board
7. Add members and assign roles (Committee Chair, Member).
8. Save the committee.

Committee detail pages include tabs for **Overview**, **Members**, and **Statistics**. Committees can schedule their own meetings, which are linked to the parent board.

9. Messaging & Chat

BoardMeets includes a full real-time messaging system for secure board communications.

9.1 Starting Conversations

1. Navigate to **Messenger** in the sidebar.
2. Click **"New Chat"** to create a new conversation.
3. Choose the conversation type:
    - 4. **Direct Message** — Select a single user for a private 1-on-1 chat
    - 5. **Group Chat** — Select multiple users and give the group a name
6. Start typing your message!

9.2 Chat Room Types

TYPE	DESCRIPTION	CREATED BY
Direct	Private 1-on-1 between two users	User-initiated
Group	Multi-user group chat with custom name	User-initiated
Board	Chat room for all board members	Automatic when board is created
Meeting	Chat room for a specific meeting's attendees	Automatic when meeting is created
Committee	Chat room for committee members	Automatic when committee is created

9.3 Chat Features

- **Real-time Messages** — Messages appear instantly via WebSocket connection
- **Typing Indicators** — See when other participants are typing
- **Online Status** — See who is online, away, or busy
- **File Sharing** — Attach files to messages
- **Replies** — Reply to specific messages to maintain context
- **Edit & Delete** — Edit or delete your own messages
- **Emoji Reactions** — React to messages with emoji
- **Read Receipts** — See who has read your messages
- **Unread Counts** — Badge counts on the conversation list and sidebar icon
- **Mute/Unmute** — Mute conversations to stop receiving notifications
- **Search** — Search within a chat room for specific messages
- **Group Management** — Add/remove participants, update group name and description
- **Participant Roles** — Admin or Member roles within group chats

> 💡 **Tip**
>
> Board, meeting, and committee chat rooms are created automatically. You don't need to set them up — just navigate to the Messenger and they will appear in your conversation list if you are a member of the respective board, meeting, or committee.

10. Notifications

10.1 Notification Types

BoardMeets sends notifications for important events across the platform:

NOTIFICATION	TRIGGERED WHEN	PRIORITY
Meeting Reminder	A meeting you are invited to is approaching	Normal
Meeting Invite	You are invited to a new meeting	Normal
Meeting Cancelled	A meeting you were attending is cancelled	High
Document Shared	A document is shared with you	Normal
Document Approved	A document you submitted is approved	Normal
Vote Open	A new vote is opened for your participation	High
Vote Closed	A vote you participated in has closed	Normal
Action Item Due	An action item assigned to you is approaching its deadline	High
Action Item Overdue	An action item assigned to you is past due	Urgent
Minutes Published	Meeting minutes have been published	Normal
Board Invite	You have been added to a board	Normal

Delivery Methods

- **In-App** — Notifications appear in the bell icon in the header and on the Notifications page
- **Email** — Sent to your registered email address
- **Push** — Browser push notifications (if enabled)

10.2 Managing Notification Preferences

Navigate to **Settings → Preferences** to customize which notifications you receive:

- Toggle email notifications on/off
- Toggle push notifications on/off
- Enable/disable specific categories: Meeting reminders, document notifications, vote notifications, action item notifications
- **Digest Frequency** — Receive a summary instead of individual emails: None, Daily, Weekly, or Monthly
- **Quiet Hours** — Set start and end times during which no notifications are sent

11. Search & Directory

Global Search

Access global search by pressing `⌘` + `K` (Mac) / `Ctrl` + `K` (Windows), or by clicking **Search** in the sidebar.

Search across all entity types:

- **Meetings** — Search by title, description
- **Boards** — Search by name
- **Documents** — Search by title, description, tags
- **Votes** — Search by title, resolution text
- **Action Items** — Search by title, description
- **Meeting Minutes** — Search within minute content

Results are ranked by relevance score and can be filtered by type. Each result shows the entity title, description excerpt, status, and associated board/meeting.

User Directory

Navigate to **Directory** in the sidebar to view all users in your organization. The directory displays user profile sheets with name, title, department, email, and the boards/committees they belong to. Use the search bar to quickly find specific colleagues.

12. Analytics & Reports

Required Permission: `analytics:view`

Navigate to **Analytics** in the sidebar for organization-wide governance metrics.

Date Range Filtering

Select a time period: Last 7 days, 30 days, 90 days, or 1 year.

Key Metrics (Stat Tiles)

- **Total Meetings** — Number of meetings held in the period
- **Boards & Members** — Active boards and total membership
- **Documents** — Documents uploaded/processed
- **Action Items** — Items created, completed, overdue
- **Votes** — Votes conducted and participation rates
- **Attendance Rate** — Average meeting attendance percentage

Charts

- **Meeting Activity Chart** — Meetings over time (scheduled, completed, cancelled)
- **Board Performance Chart** — Comparative performance across boards
- **Document Statistics Chart** — Document uploads and access patterns

13. Settings & Profile

13.1 Profile Settings

Navigate to **Settings → Profile** to manage your personal information:

- **First Name & Last Name** — Your display name
- **Email** — Read-only (contact your administrator to change)
- **Avatar** — Upload a profile photo
- **Two-Factor Authentication** — Enable/disable 2FA for added security. Once enabled, you will need an authenticator app to generate codes during login.

13.2 Display & Notification Preferences

Navigate to **Settings → Preferences**:

Display Settings

SETTING	OPTIONS
Theme	Light, Dark, or System (follows OS setting)
Date Format	MM/DD/YYYY, DD/MM/YYYY, or YYYY-MM-DD
Time Format	12-hour or 24-hour
Density	Comfortable (more spacing) or Compact (denser layout)

Notification Preferences

See Section 10.2 for detailed notification preference options.

14. Administration Guide

This chapter covers features available to **Tenant Administrators**. All administration pages are accessible from the Settings section in the sidebar.

14.1 User Management

Navigate to **Settings → Users** to manage your organization's users.

User List

Paginated table of all users with search, filter, and sort capabilities. User stats ribbon at the top shows total, active, inactive, and locked user counts.

Creating a New User

1. Click **"Create User"**.
2. Fill in the user details:
    - **Email** (required) — Must be unique within the tenant
    - **Password** — Must meet the organization's password policy. A strength indicator is shown.
    - **First Name & Last Name** (required)
    - **Middle Name & Preferred Name** (optional)
    - **Title** — Job title (e.g., "Director")
    - **Phone Number**
    - **Company & Position**
    - **Department** — Select from existing departments
    - **Timezone & Language**
    - **Date/Time Format** preferences
    - **Role** — Assign a system role
    - **Send Invitation** — Toggle to email login credentials to the user
15. Click **Create**.

Editing Users

Click any user in the list to edit their profile, change their role, reset their password, or update their department assignment.

Bulk Actions

Select multiple users and use the bulk actions toolbar to:

- Activate / Deactivate users
- Lock / Unlock accounts
- Assign a role to multiple users
- Delete users (irreversible)

14.2 Department Management

Navigate to **Settings → Departments** to organize users into departments.

- Create and name departments
- Assign users to departments using the Members dialog
- View membership counts for each department

14.3 Roles & Permissions

Navigate to **Settings → Roles** to manage roles and their associated permissions.

- View all existing roles and their permission counts
- Create new custom roles
- Edit role permissions using the permission matrix
- Use the **Permissions Comparison Table** to compare permissions across multiple roles side-by-side

> ℹ️ **Default Roles**
>
> The system comes with pre-configured roles for common board positions (Chair, Secretary, Member, Observer, etc.). These can be customized but not deleted.

14.4 Organization Settings & Branding

Navigate to **Settings → Organization** (or Tenant) to configure your organization's settings:

Organization Information

- Organization Name & Legal Name
- Domain & Subdomain
- Contact Email & Billing Email
- Phone Number
- Address

Branding

Customize the platform's visual appearance to match your organization's brand:

- **Logo** — Upload your organization's logo
- **Color Theme** — Set primary, secondary, accent, success, warning, and error colors using the color palette selector
- **Favicon** — Custom browser tab icon
- **Custom CSS** — Advanced styling overrides

A **live preview** panel shows how your branding changes will appear before saving.

Notification Settings (Organization-wide)

- Enable/disable email, push, and SMS notifications system-wide
- Set digest schedule
- Configure sender email and display name

14.5 Security Settings

Part of the Organization settings, the security panel controls:

SETTING	DESCRIPTION
Password Policy	Minimum/maximum length, required character types (uppercase, lowercase, numbers, special characters), password reuse prevention, password expiry period
Session Timeout	Duration before inactive sessions are automatically logged out
Require 2FA	Force all users to set up two-factor authentication
IP Restrictions	Restrict access to specific IP addresses or ranges
Max Login Attempts	Number of failed attempts before account lockout
Lockout Duration	How long a locked account remains locked

14.6 License & Usage

Navigate to **Settings → License** to view your organization's subscription information:

- Current plan: Basic, Professional, or Enterprise
- Usage metrics dashboard showing consumption against limits
- Feature availability based on your plan (some features are gated by plan tier)

14.7 Subsidiary Management

Organizations with the **Parent** tenant type can create and manage subsidiary tenants:

1. Navigate to **Settings → Subsidiaries**.
2. Click **"Create Subsidiary"**.
3. Configure the subsidiary's name, domain, and initial settings.
4. The subsidiary operates as an independent tenant with its own users, boards, and data.

Subsidiary Switcher

Parent tenant administrators can switch between the parent and subsidiary contexts using the **Subsidiary Switcher** in the sidebar. A banner at the top of the page indicates when you are viewing a subsidiary tenant.

> ℹ️ **Subsidiary Navigation**
>
> When viewing a subsidiary tenant, the navigation is restricted — certain features (like Boards) may be hidden based on the subsidiary configuration.

14.8 Audit Logs

Navigate to **Settings → Audit Logs** (or Audit Logs in the sidebar) to review a complete history of all actions taken in the system.

Every significant action is logged with:

- **Timestamp** — When the action occurred
- **User** — Who performed the action
- **Action** — What was done (e.g., CREATE_MEETING, UPDATE_USER, DELETE_DOCUMENT)
- **Resource Type & ID** — What entity was affected
- **Details** — Specific change details

Audit logs support filtering by date range, user, action type, and resource type.

15. Permissions Reference

The following table lists all permissions available in the BoardMeets system. Permissions are assigned to roles, and users inherit permissions through their assigned roles.

CATEGORY	PERMISSION	DESCRIPTION
System	`system:admin`	Full system administration access
	`system:manage_tenants`	Create and manage tenant organizations
Tenant	`tenant:admin`	Full tenant-level administration
	`tenant:manage_users`	Create, edit, and manage users within the tenant
Board	`board:create`	Create new boards
	`board:view`	View board details and information
	`board:edit`	Edit board settings and details
	`board:delete`	Delete/archive boards
	`board:manage_members`	Add/remove board members and change roles
Meeting	`meeting:create`	Schedule new meetings
	`meeting:view`	View meeting details, agenda, documents
	`meeting:edit`	Edit meeting details, start/end meetings
	`meeting:delete`	Cancel/delete meetings
	`meeting:approve`	Approve or reject meeting requests
	`meeting:approve_minutes`	Approve meeting minutes
Document	`document:create`	Upload and create documents
	`document:view`	View and read documents
	`document:edit`	Edit document metadata

	`document:delete`	Delete documents
Committee	`committee:create`	Create new committees
	`committee:view`	View committee details
	`committee:edit`	Edit committee settings
	`committee:manage_members`	Add/remove committee members
Voting	`vote:create`	Create new votes
	`vote:view`	View votes and results
	`vote:participate`	Cast votes
Action Items	`action_item:create`	Create new action items
	`action_item:view`	View action items
	`action_item:edit`	Edit action item details
	`action_item:assign`	Assign action items to users
Analytics	`analytics:view`	View analytics dashboards and reports
Dashboard	`dashboard:view`	View the main dashboard
Search	`search:global`	Use the global search feature

> ℹ️ **Permission Inheritance**
>
> Super Admins and Tenant Admins automatically have all permissions. Board-level permissions are scoped — a user may have `meeting:create` on Board A but not Board B, depending on their role on each board.

16. Keyboard Shortcuts & Tips

SHORTCUT	ACTION
⌘ + K / Ctrl + K	Open global search
⌘ + P / Ctrl + P	Print current page (from browser)

Tips for Efficient Use

- **Use the Dashboard** — Start each session by reviewing your dashboard. It surfaces everything that needs your attention: pending approvals, open votes, overdue action items, and upcoming meetings.
- **Set Notification Preferences Early** — Configure your notification settings in Preferences to avoid being overwhelmed or missing important updates.
- **Use Board Pack for Meeting Prep** — Before meetings, open the Documents tab to review all materials in the board pack viewer. The page indicator helps you track your progress.
- **Create Action Items During Meetings** — Don't wait until after the meeting. Create action items from the meeting detail page while context is fresh.
- **Use Chat Contextually** — Board and meeting chat rooms keep discussions organized and auditable. Prefer these over email for board-related communications.
- **Enable 2FA** — Two-factor authentication adds a critical layer of security for board governance materials.
- **Use the Calendar View** — Toggle to calendar view on the Meetings page for a visual overview of your meeting schedule.
- **Track Action Items** — Regularly update progress percentages and use the checklist feature to break complex items into smaller tasks.

17. Troubleshooting & FAQ

Q: I can't see any boards or meetings.

A: You need to be added as a member of a board to see its meetings and documents. Contact your board secretary or organization administrator to be added.

Q: I'm locked out of my account.

A: After too many failed login attempts, accounts are temporarily locked. Wait for the lockout period to expire (typically 15–30 minutes) or contact your administrator to unlock your account.

Q: I'm not receiving email notifications.

A: Check your notification preferences under Settings → Preferences. Ensure email notifications are enabled and that your digest frequency isn't set to "None" if you expect digest emails. Also check your email spam/junk folder.

Q: A meeting I know exists doesn't appear in my Upcoming tab.

A: Each tab shows meetings of a specific status. If the meeting is still a draft, it will appear in the Drafts tab. If it's pending approval, check the Pending Approval tab. Use the "All" tab to see every meeting regardless of status.

Q: I can't create a meeting/vote/document.

A: You need the appropriate permission (e.g., `meeting:create`). Your permission depends on your role on the board. Contact your board chair or organization administrator if you believe you should have this access.

Q: The document viewer isn't loading a PDF.

A: Ensure you are using a supported browser (Chrome, Firefox, Safari 16+, Edge). Try refreshing the page. If the problem persists, contact support.

Q: How do I change my password?

A: Navigate to Settings → Profile. If you don't see a password change option, your organization may require password changes through your administrator or identity provider.

Q: I submitted a vote but want to change it.

A: Once submitted, votes cannot be changed. This ensures the integrity of the voting process. Contact the vote creator if you have concerns.

Q: How do I access a subsidiary tenant?

A: Use the Subsidiary Switcher in the sidebar (visible to parent tenant administrators). Select the subsidiary you wish to view. A banner will indicate you are viewing a subsidiary.

Q: My session keeps expiring.

A: Session timeout is configured by your administrator. Active use of the platform automatically extends your session. If your session expires frequently, check with your administrator about the timeout settings.

Q: How do I enable dark mode?

A: Click the theme toggle icon in the header bar, or go to Settings → Preferences → Display Settings and set the theme to "Dark" or "System" (to follow your operating system's preference).

BoardMeets — Board Management & Governance Platform

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For support, contact your organization's administrator or email support@coseke.cloud

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